Jayakumar Pitchiah

PRODUCT MANAGER | PRODUCT & BUSINESS BUILDING

Chennai, India | Open to relocation and travel
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PROFILE

Product Manager and business builder with 10 years of professional experience, including 5+ years in product management and 9+ years at KNOW. Makes sense of complex operating needs, identifies opportunities and brings teams together to deliver practical solutions. Builds products, processes and team capability, with hands-on ownership spanning discovery, launch, adoption and continued evolution. Combines product judgment, UX/prototyping and commercial recommendations with customer-facing enablement.

EXPERIENCE

KNOW

September 2021 - Present

Product Manager

Frontline software spanning operations, learning, communication, scheduling, insights and asset management. Product ownership across discovery, prioritization, UX/prototyping, delivery and iteration.

- Identify opportunities through market research, sales conversations, support patterns and product usage; translate desired outcomes into product choices, configuration or customer solutions.
- Defined and designed a paid custom-insights offering with Data and Engineering. Built the initial proof of concept and recommended an existing visualization platform to avoid maintaining a separate engine; customers using it replaced recurring report preparation with configured views.
- Recommend commercials based on customer effort and value, with CEO approval; prioritize and coordinate ongoing integration updates with Engineering and Data, who own technical implementation and monitoring.
- Define applied-AI use cases, journeys and prototypes. Partner with Engineering, Data and AI on model choices and evaluation using human-reviewed reference examples; specify review and recovery paths for uncertain outputs.
- Prioritized learning lifecycle improvements over a broader enhancement based on demonstrated customer needs and expected usage. The shipped capability simplified onboarding-content updates, recipient visibility and completion tracking; the competing initiative was deferred.
- Challenged a requested attendance change using historical usage evidence; the customer piloted and adopted an existing capability instead, leaving the original setting unchanged.
- Review completed workflows and repeat usage weekly, combining product evidence with customer conversations. Create leadership-facing value summaries using reconfirmed customer baselines and explicit assumptions, distinguishing estimated benefits from measured outcomes.
- Create end-to-end product enablement materials used across the company in customer communications and as internal reference, enabling colleagues to explain capabilities and value independently; prepare training and launch materials with Marketing and GTM.

EXPERIENCE - CONTINUED

KNOW
September 2019 - August 2021

Product and Operations

- Built and led a four-person team; established product/process training, shared OKRs, responsibilities, performance measures and development expectations.
- Coordinated engineering, design, QA and customer-facing delivery, building operating capacity to support customers across Southeast Asia, Australia and India.

KNOW
September 2017 - August 2019

Generalist - Product, Operations and QA

- Owned Forms and Issues from discovery through prioritization, UX, engineering coordination, testing and rollout; continued their evolution in subsequent roles.
- Shaped Forms as a reusable foundation for customer workflows; continued evolution spans checklists, multi-stage handovers, expenses, permits and audits through configuration, with conditional questions, task creation and integrations.
- Investigated unmet scheduling needs and informed product direction; worked across onboarding, implementation, QA, support and GTM during the company's early stage.

Crayon'd
March - August 2017

Business Analyst

- Ran client discovery and translated requirements into product flows and specifications; coordinated stakeholder reviews and release quality checks with engineers and designers.
- Worked across restaurant discovery, taxation, e-commerce and fundraising products, adapting requirements to different domains.

Stealth startup
September 2016 - March 2017

Business Analyst

- Researched an inventory-management opportunity through market analysis, customer interviews and assumption validation; built customer-specific solutions with no-code tools.

EDUCATION & DEVELOPMENT

B.E., Electrical, Electronics and Communications Engineering
Kumaraguru College of Technology | 2012 - 2016

Product Academy Fundamentals | McKinsey & Company | 2022

Early experience: hardware and embedded-systems prototyping at iQube Innovation Center (student innovation club), 2013 - 2016; Bosch trainee, May 2014.

COMMUNITY

ProductTank Chennai organizer; mentor to students exploring technology careers.